

Glossary of Key Terms : Emotional Interaction

Emotional Interaction

How people feel and react when using technology, such as feeling happy, frustrated, relaxed, or motivated.

Example: Feeling annoyed when a website is slow or happy when an app is easy to use.

Emotional Design

Designing technology in a way that creates desired emotional responses in users.

Example: A shopping app using warm colors and smooth animations to make users feel comfortable.

Affective Computing

A field that focuses on how computers can recognize, interpret, and respond to human emotions.

Example: A system detecting stress from facial expressions and voice tone.

Emotional AI

The use of AI to automatically measure and predict human emotions using data like facial expressions, voice, and behavior.

Example: A website detecting if a user looks frustrated and changing its recommendations.

Emotive Feedback

Feedback designed to trigger emotional reactions in users.

Example: A fitness app showing a sad face when you miss your exercise goal.

Automatic Emotions (Affect)

Quick emotional reactions that happen instantly and disappear quickly.

Example: Jumping in fear after hearing a sudden loud noise.

Conscious Emotions (Reflect)

Slower emotions that last longer and involve thinking and reflection.

Example: Staying annoyed for hours because of a noisy hotel room.

Visceral Level

The immediate emotional reaction to how something looks, sounds, or feels.

Example: Loving a phone because it looks beautiful at first sight.

Behavioral Level

The emotions created while actually using a product, based on usability and performance.

Example: Feeling satisfied because an app is easy to use and works smoothly.

Reflective Level

The emotional connection based on personal meaning, memories, and long-term value.

Example: Keeping an old watch because it reminds you of your graduation.

Usability

How easy and efficient a product is to use.

Example: A website with clear buttons and simple navigation has good usability.

Cognitive Load

The amount of mental effort needed to use a system.

Example: Too many confusing options on a screen increase cognitive load.

Expressive Interface

An interface that uses visuals, sounds, colors, animations, or icons to communicate feelings and create emotional connection.

Example: Emojis in a messaging app or a “ding” sound for a new email.

Sonification

Using sound to represent actions or events in a system.

Example: A “whoosh” sound when deleting a file.

Vibrotactile Feedback

Using vibration to communicate information or feelings.

Example: Different phone vibrations for different types of notifications.

Anthropomorphism

Giving human qualities, feelings, or behavior to non-human objects or technology.

Example: Treating Alexa like a person or feeling bad when a virtual pet looks sad.

Virtual Agent

A digital character designed to interact with users like a human assistant.

Example: Microsoft’s Clippy or IKEA’s Anna.

Plutchik's Wheel of Emotions

A model that organizes emotions into primary emotions and shows how they combine into more complex feelings.

Example: Joy + Trust = Love.

Primary Emotions

The basic emotions in Plutchik's model.

Example: Joy, sadness, fear, anger, surprise, trust, disgust, and anticipation.

Secondary Emotions

Emotions formed by combining two primary emotions.

Example: Joy + Trust = Love.

Facial Coding

Using AI to identify emotions by analyzing facial expressions.

Example: Detecting happiness from smiling or disgust from nose wrinkling.

Galvanic Skin Response (GSR)

A measurement of skin activity used to detect emotional states like stress or excitement.

Example: Sweaty palms during nervousness can increase GSR.

Mood Tracking

Using technology to record and reflect on mood changes over time.

Example: Apps like Moodnotes or Daylio help users monitor daily emotions.

Behavioral Change

Designing technology to influence people's actions, habits, or decisions.

Example: A reminder app encouraging users to drink more water.

Nudging

A gentle design technique that encourages people to make better choices without forcing them.

Example: Amazon's 1-click purchase or reminders to save energy.

Sustainable HCI

Designing technology to help people reduce waste and energy use and support environmental responsibility.

Example: A smart meter showing home electricity usage to encourage saving energy.

Social Robot

A robot designed to interact socially with humans and provide companionship, support, or care.

Example: A robot helping elderly people in retirement homes feel less lonely.